

TRUST AND SAFETY AUDIT: INTENTION DOCUMENT

New York University Tandon School of Engineering
Computer Science and Engineering
Spring 2026

Instructor:	Prof. Rosanna Bellini	Time:	Monday 11.00 AM – 1.30 PM
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Office Hours:	Tue 12:30 – 1:30PM*	Office:	370 Jay Street, Office 1056

*Please email me to set up an appointment at any other time.

Introduction

Over the course of the Fall semester, you will work in **groups of 2–3 people** to conduct original research in the area of Trust and Safety. **Each team member needs to upload a copy of the final document into BrightSpace.**

This document formalizes the formation of your group that you have chosen to conduct a Trust and Safety Audit with. This document should also outline your project's initial direction and is worth 10% of your grade. It will be evaluated on clarity, relevance to course themes (see Syllabus), feasibility (i.e., can you achieve your goals?), and methodological soundness (e.g., is it clear what you will accomplish).

You should use either the **USENIX Security Overleaf template** (Overleaf v.2023) or the **Word template** (Word v.2022) for this document. This is the same template as the mid-point check-in document (so feel free to continue using the same document). Purple writing like this is used as placeholders to provide an example. Your *Intention Document* should contain information as follows:

Group

Each group should consist of 2–3 students unless otherwise been awarded special permission from Rosie. Please share who will be in your team, and provide their details in a table like the one below:

Name	NetID	Program / Year	Email Address
Person Name 1	anon592	MS Cybersecurity	anon592@nyu.edu
Person Name 2	anon259	BS Mechanical Engineering	anon259@nyu.edu
Person Name 3	anon925	MS Computer Science	anon925@nyu.edu

Table 1: Please change values to be in line with actual team names

Project Options

Check or embolden **one** of the following options. Remember: The expectation of effort for both options is the same – the latter simply provides more structure while the former is more open-ended. The project milestones, submission requirements, and grading criteria are the **same** for both options.

- Option One: Original Research Idea (Develop your own Trust & Safety-related project idea and execute it as a team.)
- Option Two: Platform Measurement Project (Select a platform and harm type, develop an automated detector, and analyze the system.)

Working title (optional): #NoFilter: Detecting Disinformation in Image Reposts.

A concise, descriptive title for your project (this can evolve later)

Project Summary

Describe the main focus of your proposed group project; this is a little bit like a pitch. A good summary will set the scene as to the problem or harm you are going to be looking at for the remainder of the semester; so, pick something that you don't mind exploring for. Setting the scene means explaining what research has been done before, or citing a mainstream media article which highlights an issue.

Following this, you should explain what research question(s) you are going to be investigating, and specifically what motivates this focus; what is missing or overlooked from previous approaches? This can be through appeals to who or what might be impacted by this harm.

Finally, a good summary gives a general overview as to what you intend to do; including the methods, the type of data you will be analyzing, and the expected findings.

Connection to Trust & Safety Themes

Explain how your project relates to concepts, frameworks, or readings from this course; this part is especially important if you select Option One (an original research idea). To do this, you may reference specific lectures from the Syllabus shared on BrightSpace (e.g., "Abuse Vectors", "Content Moderation", "Red Teaming") and explain how it fits in with that class' material, such as specific slides or activities that you participated in with your colleagues. You can also mention any of the readings you were set for Reading Responses, or works referenced in the class (e.g., Daffalla et al.)

Research or Measurement Plan

Outline your intended method or approach, depending on your project type. Being clear as to what type of method you choose is important as you will be evaluated on how feasible it is that you can accomplish the project using it. If are going to rely on human participants (e.g., via interviews, surveys, cognitive walkthroughs), you must be prepared to submit an Institutional Review Board request prior to the collection of any data. This section should outline the types of data you are looking to collect (e.g., forum content, metadata), how much of it, and the type of analysis you will be applying.

You should be able to answer the following questions through the prose you contribute to this section.

Optional One: Original Research Idea

1. What are your guiding research questions?
2. What methods do you plan to use (e.g., interviews, content analysis, audits, simulation, system walkthroughs)?
3. What is your anticipated data source or site of inquiry?
4. What will you be measuring, mapping, or evaluating?

Optional Two: Platform Measurement Project

1. What are your guiding research questions?
2. What harm type will you study (e.g., harassment, deception, sexualization, exploitation)?
3. What platform or ecosystem will you focus on?

4. What automated detection approach (keyword matching, classifier, rule-based, etc.) might you build?

Anticipated Challenges or Risks

Demonstrate foresight and critical awareness of the ethical, technical, and practical risks inherent in your proposed project. A strong response goes beyond generic statements (“we will anonymize data”) to show engagement with how and why specific risks may emerge from your research activities, and what specific, practical steps you will put down to mitigate them.

This section will be evaluated based on specificity, realism (i.e., will something actually happen), and fit between risks and suggested mitigations. The best submissions will include ethical reasoning with technical awareness and show that you have seriously considered feasibility, safety, and integrity in your research proposal.

Expected Outcomes

Explain what your team will hope to deliver by the end of the semester; or in other words, what will the main course of the Final Report and Presentation be? This could be anything from a prototype of a detector of cyberbullying on Snapchat, to a deep dive into how policy approaches to moderating pro-anorexic content (e.g., pro-ana) content has adapted over time across three specific platforms, or offer a series of a design recommendations for child-safe smartphones.

Division of Roles (Optional)

If known, describe how your group plans to divide work across members. (E.g., data collection, analysis, writing, visualization, communication). While this section is not marked, this is a helpful exercise for thinking through who will be doing what and areas where you might have shared responsibilities.

Marking Rubric

Criterion	Excellent	Proficient	Developing	Limited/Unfinished	Marks
Clarity, Structure, and Presentation	Writing is polished, concise, and logically organized. All sections complete and formatted correctly. Free of grammar or style errors.	Mostly clear and organized; minor issues in flow or formatting; minor typos.	Writing occasionally unclear or disjointed; inconsistent formatting or missing section headers.	Unclear or incomplete; poor organization or significant grammar/formatting issues.	20
Relevance to T&S Themes	Strong and specific links to multiple course themes; demonstrates deep understanding of T&S content.	Clear connection to at least one course theme or reading.	Mentions course concepts but connection is vague or underdeveloped.	Lacks any meaningful link to course content or T&S broadly.	10
Project Summary	Interesting and clearly scoped problem; strong motivation and relevance; identifies stakeholders (e.g., platforms) and harms precisely.	Clear problem and rationale; some gaps in scope or stakeholder framing.	Problem too broad, generic, or weakly motivated; unclear target audience or harms.	Problem missing or unrelated to T&S context.	20
Feasibility & Methodological Soundness	Methods, data sources, and timeline are detailed, realistic, and coherent; clearly achievable within the semester.	Sound plan with minor feasibility or methodological issues.	Plan lacks specificity or feasibility; unclear data access or methodological rigor.	Plan implausible, incoherent, or absent.	20
Anticipated Risks or Challenges	Identifies multiple credible risks (ethical, technical, practical) and offers thoughtful mitigation strategies.	Identifies one or more realistic risks and partial mitigation plan.	Mentions general risks with little depth or detail.	No discussion of challenges or mitigation.	20
Expected Outcomes	Expected outcomes are specific, measurable, and align with methods and course goals.	Outcomes described clearly but somewhat generic or lacking detail.	Outcomes vague or not directly connected to the plan.	Outcomes missing or unrealistic.	10

Table 2: Marking Rubric for Intention Document, Scored out of 100